

Meeting Summaries of July 24th and 25th, 2025

Date: July 24th, 2025

Time: 19:00–19:40 PM(PCT)

Attendees: Prof. Jan, Prof.Jabed, Prof.Yue, and Feng

Topic: Feng’s report on the first draft of the proposal and feedback from supervisors

Summary of Discussion

- Feng discussed the first draft of the proposal and outlined the sections that still need to be completed this week: *Methodology*, *Preliminary Results*, and *Timeline*.
- Feng reported a mismatch across the three datasets, particularly in the number of observations: the stressor dataset contains 104 observations, whereas the other two datasets—the environmental dataset (either 225 observations with the water velocity variable for the Detroit River, or 311 observations without it for the entire corridor) and the taxa dataset (311 observations across the entire corridor)—differ in coverage.¹
- Prof. Jan noted that this mismatch is not a major issue. Complete stressor data are available for both the entire corridor and the Detroit River. Once the full stressor dataset is incorporated, a consistent dataset for the Detroit River with 225 observations—including the water velocity variable—will be available.

Table 1: Two factors influencing data completeness and the number of observations in each scenario

Stressor Data (104)	Water Velocity (225)	Number of Observations
Available	Available	around 20 (Detroit River)
Available	Not Available	around 84 (Except Detroit River)
Not Available	Available	225 - around 20 (Detroit River)
Not Available	Not Available	304 - above numbers (mixed over the entire corridor)

Decisions Made

- The remaining stressor data for the Detroit River will be incorporated into the dataset.

¹The dataset with 311 observations for the entire corridor includes the 225 Detroit River observations as a subset. However, the stressor dataset (104 observations) is not a subset of the 225-observation Detroit River dataset, but rather a subset of the full 311-observation corridor dataset.

- The current dataset includes a subset of observations (approximately 20) with the water velocity variable, which supports preliminary analysis focused on the Detroit River. The remaining observations (approximately 84) without water velocity data can support initial analyses for other parts of the corridor. Thus, proceeding with preliminary analysis using the currently available data is acceptable, even though the limited sample size should be acknowledged.
- Prof. Javed recommended that Feng adopt a more academic tone in writing, although the current style is generally not bad.

Action Items

- Feng will complete the *Methodology* section, organize the overall workflow, and create a basic flowchart to illustrate the process. Preliminary analyses will be conducted on the current dataset within this framework.
- Feng will incorporate the above content into the proposal and submit the second draft by July 30th, 2025.
- Prof. Jan will locate the remaining stressor data stored on another computer and share it with Feng once available.
- Feng is prepared and willing to assist with data cleaning for the additional dataset, if needed.

Follow-Up

Temporary meeting time: July 30th, 2025, 19:00–20:00 PM(PCT) via Zoom.

Supportive materials

- A meeting recording was stored in Feng's laptop for reviewing.
- A pdf of the first draft of the proposal was shared in this meeting was stored locally.

Date: July 25th, 2025

Time: 16:45–17:30 PM(PCT)

Attendees: Prof.Yue, and Feng

Topic: Feng's report about the framework of the proposal and feedback from Prof.Yue

Summary of Discussion

- Feng presented the framework of the proposal, including the overall research objectives, methodology, and connection between each methodology step and the data information.
- Prof. Yue asked some questions about the data sets and the major analysis planned to be conducted on them.

- Feng organized the workflow along the questions raised by Prof. Yue, and noticed some details in the data sets.

End here.